

long time back, XP remains the choice of platform for most game developers and almost every major release is made to run on it. Vista can handle almost all of them with some requiring you to run in Compatibility mode and some working better than they do on XP. There is no shortage of compatible gaming accessories for both XP and Vista alike.

While Vista added support for DirectX 10 gaming, Windows 7 comes with DirectX 11 - a graphics and sound standard which delivers better image quality, new effects, 3D and improved performance show your graphics card is Dx11 compatible. Windows 7 also does not have any performance issues like Vista and utilises RAM better both XP and Vista. If you have a mid range spec-ed computer, Windows 7's gaming performance will impress you with higher frame rates in general. While it cannot handle older DOS games like XP, we would still go with Windows 7>XP>Vista for gaming because once game developers start utilising Dx11, games will come alive in full 3D glory on your computer.

### 1.2.6 Startup and shutdown

Startup Time is not really a factor when you judge the performance of an Operating System because most power users start their computer only once a day. But its an important consideration for an average user who uses his computer for short intervals spread over different times in the day. He will expect the computer to start as fast as possible. Another consideration is the fact that Start-up and Shut-down times are the first directly measurable indication of OS's speed.

We tested all the three Operating systems on a laptop with 2.4 GHz (P8400) Centrino 2 processor, 4 GB of RAM at 800 MHz FSB and a 7200 RPM hard-disk drive. Windows 7 took 23 seconds to bring the desktop, whereas XP took 27 seconds and Vista faired a high 34 seconds. Now, there is a difference between appearance of the Desktop and the full start-up of an Operating system since a lot of services in Windows 7 and Vista are scheduled to 'delay-start'. To compare that, we started Windows and measured the time it took to connect to the internet, Open Internet Explorer and open Google.com Homepage. Windows 7 gets to work quickly and after the appearance of the desktop it took only a further 3 seconds to display the Google homepage. Compared to this, Vista took more than 8 seconds and XP took a competitive 4 seconds. The whole startup process for Windows 7 up to the appearance of Google took 26 seconds. Vista takes 42 seconds and XP 31 seconds.